

Module 2

Your First Model — Tier 1: Beginner

1. Understanding Design Tools (Without Learning to Model)

You don't need to become a CAD expert to start printing your own designs. There are two main paths beginners take:

- **Downloading existing models** — the fastest path; thousands of free, ready-to-print files exist
- **Editing existing models** — using simple parametric tools to tweak size, add text, or combine parts
- **Modeling from scratch** — the deepest path, covered later in Tier 2 (Module 6)

For your first model, you'll use path 1: downloading a free, tested, ready-to-print file.

2. Where to Find Free Models

Platform	Notes
MakerWorld	Bambu Lab's platform — huge library, built-in slicer profiles, beginner-friendly
Printables	Prusa's platform — large community, strong search/filter tools
Thingiverse	One of the oldest libraries — huge selection, quality varies more

Look for models with high print-success ratings, clear photos of completed prints, and comments confirming settings worked.

3. Downloading & Preparing Your File

- Files are typically **.STL** or **.3MF** — both are 3D shape files your slicer can open
- **.3MF** often includes pre-set print settings from the designer — easier for beginners
- Download to a folder you'll remember — you'll import this directly into your slicer next (Module 3)

4. Picking a Good First Model

- Small size (fits easily on your bed, prints in under 2 hours)
- No supports required (flat bottom, no big overhangs)

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- Single color / single material
 - High number of "Made" photos from other users — proof it prints reliably

Good beginner picks: a simple phone stand, a small container, or a calibration test model (like a "3D Benchy" boat — the community-standard test print).

End of Module 2 — Next: Module 3, Slicing 101